and it is in regard to this that clarification is necessary.' Therefore I don't think any useful purpose will be served to carry on correspondence with regard to the various matters mentioned in your letter. You will please not introduce matter which you may have discussed with Nawab Ismail Khan or Choudhry Khaliquzzaman or anybody else. These again will lead to references and cross references and the matter will never end.

As regards my Calcutta speech, the word 'challenge' is obviously due to the imagination of the reporter for the very context shows clearly that it was an invitation. However, the discussion of all these matters in correspondence will lead us nowhere. I do not believe in the doctrine which you lay down 'but are we not entitled to ask you to substantiate all these criticisms in private at least, if not in public': I for my part make no such distinction. I am prepared to substantiate anything that I have said publicly, provided it is correctly reported. The crux of your letter on the real vital point of the Hindu-Muslim unity is a repetition of what you said in your previous letter, namely, that you want me to note down 'the points of difference' and discuss them through and by means of correspondence – a method, which I made it clear in my last letter, is highly undesirable and most inappropriate. I welcome your suggestion when you say, 'whenever necessity arises every one of us would willingly welcome a talk'. If you think that necessity has arisen and any one of you is willing, I shall be glad to see you and equally welcome a talk. The thing is that you prefer talking at each other whereas I prefer talking to each other. Surely you know and you ought to know what are the fundamental points in dispute.

I have received a letter from Mr Gandhi and I have replied to him, a copy of which I am enclosing herewith.

Yours sincerely,

M.A. Jinnah

Nehru to Jinnah - 25 February 1938

Bombay